

PRASANTHI RAMAKRISHNAN

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APPOINTMENTS

Southern Methodist University
Assistant Professor of Economics

08/2023 -

EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis
Ph.D. in Economics

2023

London School of Economics and Political Science
M.Sc. in Economics

2013

Hansraj College, University of Delhi
B.A. (Honours) Economics

2012

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Labor Economics, Health Economics, Applied Econometrics
Secondary: Entrepreneurship, Family Economics

RESEARCH

Publications

- [Work, Leisure and Family: From the Silent Generation to Millennials](#) (with George-Levi Gayle and Mariana Odio-Zúñiga). *Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis Review*, Fourth Quarter 2021, 103(4), pp. 385-424.

Working Papers

- [Gender and Mentorship in Entrepreneurship](#) (with Chuan Chen and Barton Hamilton) (*R&R at Journal of Labor Economics*)
- [Moving for Marriage: When Does Migration Empower Women?](#) (with Jacek Barszczewski and Sophie Brochet) (*R&R at Journal of Development Economics*)
- [Education, Marriage, and Social Security](#)
- [Estimating Moral Hazard in Healthcare Utilization from a Large Scale Policy Experiment: *Universal Healthcare, Not Universal Benefit*](#) (with George-Levi Gayle, Peter-John Gordon and Devon Lynch)

Work in Progress

- Beyond the Paycheck: Understanding Financial Decision-Making (with Vasudha Nukala)
- Old Age Inequality Over Generations
- The Gendered Impact of Structural Transformation: Evidence from India's Service Sector (with Minyoung Song)
- Two Year College Choice (with Edward Honda)
- Marriage, Divorce, and Social Security over Generations

Resting Papers

- [Entrepreneurship in Black and White](#) (with Barton Hamilton, Andrés Hincapié and Siddhartha Sanghi)

Other Publications

- [What Can Be Done to Promote Black Entrepreneurship?](#) (with Siddhartha Sanghi, Maggie Isaacson, Barton H. Hamilton, Andrés Hincapié). *The Regional Economist*. Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis.
- [A Comment on 'Populist Leaders and the Economy'](#) (with Shih-Hsien Chuang, Matthew Holian, and Nathaniel Pattison), I4R Discussion Paper Series (2024), No. 157, Institute for Replication (I4R)

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- Bush Institute-SMU Economic Growth Initiative Research Grants (\$5,000) 2025
- SMU University Research Council (URC) Grant (\$10,000) 2024
- Bush Institute-SMU Economic Growth Initiative Research Grants (\$10,000) 2023
- Boston College Center for Retirement Research and Social Security Administration Dissertation Fellowship (\$28,000) 2021 - 2022
- Federal Reserve Board of Governors Dissertation Fellowship Summer 2021
- Summer Fellowship, Washington University in St. Louis 2018, 2019
- University Fellowship, Washington University in St. Louis 2016 - 2020
- Travel Awards: Center for Research in Economics and Strategy (CRES), Olin Business School (2020); Graduate School of Arts and Sciences, WashU (2020); Department of Economics, WashU (2020)

TEACHING

Instructor, Southern Methodist University

- Labor Economics (undergraduate) Fall 2023, Spring 2025
- Labor Economics (Ph.D.) Spring 2025

Teaching Assistant, Washington University in St. Louis

- Structural Microeconometrics Spring 2020

Teaching Assistant, Olin Business School

- Research in Healthcare Management Spring 2020

RESEARCH PRIOR TO PH.D

- [Sex Ratio Imbalances and Marriage Squeeze in India: 2000-2050](#). (with Ravinder Kaur, Surjit Bhalla and Manoj Agrawal). UNFPA India. 2016.
- [Sex Ratio at Birth - Role of Gender, Class and Education](#). (with Ravinder Kaur, Surjit Bhalla and Manoj Agrawal). UNFPA India. 2016.
- [Sex Ratio Imbalances and Crime Rates](#). (with Ravinder Kaur, Surjit Bhalla and Manoj Agrawal). UNFPA India. 2016.

Other Research Experience

- Research Assistant for Prof. George-Levi Gayle and Prof. Limor Golan 2017 - 2023

- Research Assistant for Prof. Barton Hamilton 2017 - 2020
- Research Assistant for Dr. Surjit Bhalla, Oxus Investments 10/2013 - 05/2016
- Consultant, United Nations Population Fund 07/2014 - 12/2015
- Research Assistant to Dr. Gill Wyness and Dr. Richard Murphy, Centre for Economic Performance, LSE 07/2013 - 12/2013

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Presentations *: *scheduled*

- 2026: WEAI*, Minneapolis Fed*, Johns Hopkins*
- 2025: MEA 2025, WEAI, Eleventh ECINEQ Conference, GLO-JOPE (Online)
- 2024: Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop (discussant), WEAI, Dynamic Structural Models Conference, Southern Economics Association, Society for Economic Dynamics (winter)
- 2023: Southern Methodist University, Temple University, ITAM, Melbourne Institute, University of New South Wales, Toulouse School of Economics, Ohio State University, Southern Economics Association, Delhi Winter School 2023
- 2022: Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, SEHO 2022, SEA 2022, Chicago Booth Rising Scholars Conference 2022, IIT Kanpur
- 2021: Barcelona GSE Summer Forum (Structural Micro), Society for Economic Dynamics, PAA (Discussant), Federal Reserve Board of Governors (x2), Economics Graduate Student Conference (WashU), Olin Business School Econ Brownbag
- 2020 and earlier: Australian Gender Economics Workshop, AOM 2020, EEA Virtual 2020, Economics Graduate Student Conference 2020 (WashU), Economics Graduate Student Conference 2019 (WashU)

Department Service, Southern Methodist University

- Junior Hiring Committee 2023-24, 2024-25

Department Service, Washington University in St. Louis

- President, Economics Graduate Student Association (GSA) 2019 - 2020
- Senator, Graduate Student Senate & Student Representative, Graduate Council 2019 - 2020
- Organizer, 13th Economics Graduate Student Conference (EGSC) 2018

Referee Services

- *Journal of Human Capital, Quantitative Economics, Research in Economics, Social Science Research*

PH.D. ADVISING

- Ayus Mitra (committee member)
- Suchetana Das (committee member)

OTHER

- Software and Tools: STATA, MATLAB, Fortran
- Languages: English (Fluent), Hindi (Fluent), Telugu (Native), Tamil (Basic), French (Basic)
- Citizenship: India (H-1B Visa)

Last updated: June 4, 2026